

Homogenous Products

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Grad IO

One of the earliest exercises in econometrics is the estimation of supply and demand for a homogenous product

- ▶ According to Stock and Trebbi (2003) IV regression first appeared in a book by Phillip G. Wright in 1928 entitled *The Tariff on Animal and Vegetable Oils* [neatly tucked away in Appendix B: Supply and Demand for Butter and Flaxseed.]
- ▶ Lots of similar studies of simultaneity of supply + demand for similar agricultural products or commodities.

Supply and Demand For Coffee, everything is linear

$$Q_t^d = \alpha_0 + \alpha_1 P_t + U_t$$

$$Q_t^s = \beta_0 + \beta_1 P_t + V_t$$

$$Q_t^d = Q_t^s$$

Solving for P_t, Q_t :

$$P_t = \frac{\beta_0 - \alpha_0}{\alpha_1 - \beta_1} + \frac{V_t - U_t}{\alpha_1 - \beta_1}$$

$$Q_t = \frac{\alpha_1 \beta_0 - \alpha_0 \beta_1}{\alpha_1 - \beta_1} + \frac{\alpha_1 V_t - \beta_1 U_t}{\alpha_1 - \beta_1}$$

Price is a function of both error terms, and we can't use a clever substitution to cancel things out.

To make things really obvious:

$$\begin{aligned}Cov(P_t, U_t) &= -\frac{Var(U_t)}{\alpha_1 - \beta_1} \\Cov(P_t, V_t) &= \frac{Var(V_t)}{\alpha_1 - \beta_1}\end{aligned}$$

- When demand slopes down ($\alpha_1 < 0$) and supply slopes up ($\beta_1 > 0$) then price is positively correlated with demand shifter U_t and negatively correlated with supply shifter V_t .

$$Cov(P_t, Q_t^d) = \alpha_1 Var P_t + Cov(P_t, U_t)$$

$$Cov(P_t, Q_t^s) = \beta_1 Var P_t + Cov(P_t, V_t)$$

► Bias in OLS estimate (Demand) $Bias(\alpha_1) = \frac{Cov(P_t, U_t)}{Var P_t}$.

► Bias in OLS estimate (Supply) $Bias(\beta_1) = \frac{Cov(P_t, V_t)}{Var P_t}$.

► We can actually write both this way when $Cov(U_t, V_t) = 0$:

$$\text{OLS Estimate} = \frac{\alpha_1 Var(V_t) + \beta_1 Var(U_t)}{Var(V_t) + Var(U_t)}$$

► More variation in supply $V_t \rightarrow$ better estimate of demand.

► More variation in demand $U_t \rightarrow$ better estimate of supply.

► Led Working to say the **statistical demand function** (OLS) is not informative about the economic demand function (or supply function).

- ▶ For most of you, this was probably a review: we know the solution is an **excluded instrument** that shifts one curve without affecting the other, which we can use to form a 2SLS estimate.
- ▶ Instead let's look at something a little different: Angrist, Imbens, and Graddy (ReStud 2000).
 - Demand for Whiting (fish) at Fulton Fish Market
 - Do not place functional form restrictions on demand (log-log, log-linear, linear, etc.).
 - “What does linear IV regression of Q on P identify, even if the true (but unknown) demand function is nonlinear”
 - Takes a program evaluation/treatment effects approach to understanding the “causal effect” of price on quantity demanded.
 - Aside: Is there even such a thing as the causal effect of price on quantity demanded?

Four Cases

Ranked in increasing complexity

1. Linear system with constant coefficients

$$q_t^d(p, z, x) = \alpha_0 + \alpha_1 p + \alpha_2 z + \alpha_3 x + \epsilon_t$$

$$q_t^s(p, z, x) = \beta_0 + \beta_1 p + \beta_2 z + \beta_3 x + \eta_t$$

2. Linear system with non-constant coefficients

$$q_t^d(p, z, x) = \alpha_{0t} + \alpha_{1t} p + \alpha_{2t} z + \alpha_{3t} x + \epsilon_t$$

$$q_t^s(p, z, x) = \beta_{0t} + \beta_{1t} p + \beta_{2t} z + \beta_{3t} x + \eta_t$$

3. Nonlinear system with constant shape (separable)

$$q_t^d(p, z, x) = q^d(p, z, x) + \epsilon_t$$

$$q_t^s(p, z, x) = q^s(p, z, x) + \eta_t$$

4. Nonlinear system with time-varying shape (non-separable)

$$q_t^d(p, z, x) = q^d(p, z, x, \epsilon_t)$$

$$q_t^s(p, z, x) = q^s(p, z, x, \eta_t)$$

Two kinds:

1. Heterogeneity depending on value of p fixing t (only relevant in nonlinear models)
 2. Heterogeneity across t , fixing p (cases 2 and 4).
- ▶ The problem is that we don't generally know which kind of heterogeneity we face.
 - ▶ Is case (4) hopeless? Or what can we expect to learn?
 - ▶ Even econometricians struggle with non-linear non-separable models (!)

Assume binary instrument $z_t \in \{0, 1\}$ to make things easier.

1. Regularity conditions on $q_t^d, q_t^s, p_t, z_t, w_t$ first and second moment and is stationary, etc.
 - $q_t^d(p, z, x), q_t^s(p, z, x)$ are continuously differentiable in p .
2. z_t is a valid instrument in q_t^d
 - Exclusion: for all p, t

$$q_t^d(p, z = 1, x_t) = q_t^d(p, z = 0, x_t) \equiv q_t^d(p, x_t)$$

ie: conditioning on p_t means no dependence on z_t

- Relevance: for some period t : $q_t^s(p_t, 1, x_t) \neq q_t^s(p_t, 0, x_t)$.

ie: z_t actually shifts supply somewhere!

- Independence: ϵ_t, η_t, z_t are mutually independent conditional on x_t .

Focus on the simple case:

- ▶ $z \in \{0, 1\}$ where 1 denotes “stormy at sea” and 0 denotes “calm at sea”
- ▶ Idea is that offshore weather makes fishing more difficult but doesn’t change onshore demand.
- ▶ Ignore x (for now at least) or assume we condition on each value of x .

$$\hat{\alpha}_{1,0} \rightarrow^p \frac{\mathbb{E}[q_t | z_t = 1] - \mathbb{E}[q_t | z_t = 0]}{\mathbb{E}[p_t | z_t = 1] - \mathbb{E}[p_t | z_t = 0]} \equiv \alpha_{1,0}$$

- ▶ If we are in case (1) then we are good. In fact, any IV gives us a consistent estimate of α_1
- ▶ If we are in case (4) then $\alpha_{1,0}$ the object we recover, is not an estimator of a structural parameter.
- ▶ Moreover, this is at best a LATE, and thus it differs depending on which instrument we use!

- ▶ Should we divorce structural estimation from estimating “deep” population parameters (as suggested by Lucas critique)?
- ▶ Authors make the point that IV estimator identifies something about relationship between p and q , without identifying deep structural parameters?
- ▶ In IO this is a somewhat heretical idea (especially to start the course with).

In order to interpret the Wald estimator $\alpha_{1,0}$ we make some additional **economic** assumptions on the structure of the problem:

1. Observed price is market clearing price $q_t^d(p_t) = q_t^s(p_t, z_t)$ for all t . (This means no frictions!).
2. “Potential prices”: for each value of z there is a unique market clearing price

$$\forall z, t : \tilde{p}(z, t) \text{ s.t. } q_t^d(\tilde{p}(z, t)) = q_t^s(\tilde{p}(z, t), z).$$

$\tilde{p}(z, t)$ is the potential price under any counterfactual (z, t)

- ▶ Just like in IV we need denominator to be nonzero so that $E[p_t|z_t = 1] \neq E[p_t|z_t = 0]$.
- ▶ Other key assumption is the familiar **monotonicity** assumption
 - $\tilde{p}(z, t)$ is weakly increasing in z .
 - Just like in program evaluation this is the key assumption. There it rules out “defiers” here it allows us to interpret the **average slope** as $\alpha_{1,0}$.
 - Assumption is untestable because you do not observe both potential outcomes $\tilde{p}(0, t)$ and $\tilde{p}(1, t)$ (same as in program evaluation).
 - Any story about IV is just a story! (Always the case!) unless we have repeated observations on the same individual.

The key result establishes that the numerator of $\alpha_{1,0}$:

$$\mathbb{E}[q_t | z_t = 1] - \mathbb{E}[q_t | z_t = 0] = \mathbb{E}_t \left[\int_{\tilde{p}(0,t)}^{\tilde{p}(1,t)} \frac{\partial q_t^d(s)}{\partial s} d s \right]$$

- For each t we average over the slope of demand curve among the two potential prices:

$$\int_{\tilde{p}(0,t)}^{\tilde{p}(1,t)} \frac{\partial q_t^d(s)}{\partial s} d s$$

- This range could differ for each t .
- Then we average this average over all t .

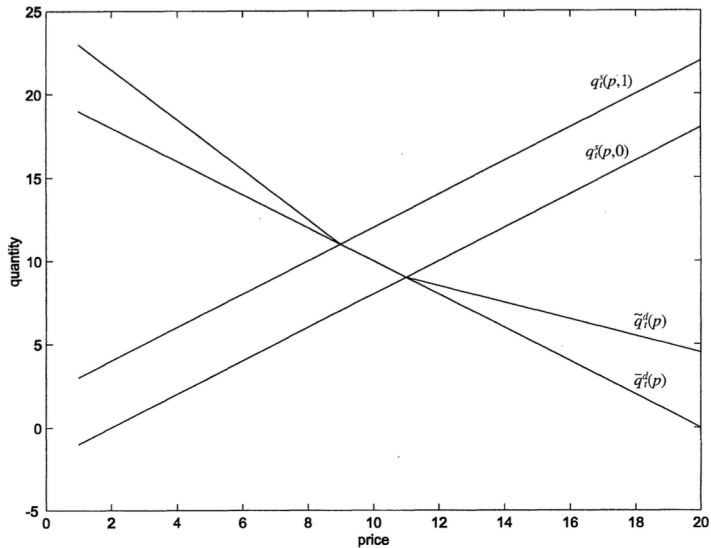


FIGURE 1

The Wald estimand is a weighted average of demand slopes:

$$\alpha_{1,0} = \frac{\mathbb{E}[\int_{\tilde{p}(0,t)}^{\tilde{p}(1,t)} \frac{\partial q_t^d(s)}{\partial s} ds]}{\mathbb{E}\tilde{p}(1,t) - \mathbb{E}\tilde{p}(0,t)} \rightarrow \int_0^\infty \mathbb{E}\left[\frac{\partial q_t^d(s)}{\partial s} \mid s \in [\tilde{p}(0,t), \tilde{p}(1,t)]\right] \omega(s) ds$$

- ▶ Given t : average the slope of q_t^d from $\tilde{p}(0,t)$ to $\tilde{p}(1,t)$. Given price s : average across t (randomness is due to ϵ_t).
- ▶ Weight $\omega(s)$ is not a function of t but it is largest for prices most likely to fall between $\tilde{p}(0,t)$ and $\tilde{p}(1,t)$.
- ▶ Case (2): $q_t^d(p) = \alpha_{0t} + \alpha_{1t}p + \epsilon_t$ gives $\alpha_{1,0} = \frac{\mathbb{E}[\alpha_{1t}(\tilde{p}(1,t) - \tilde{p}(0,t))]}{\mathbb{E}\tilde{p}(1,t) - \mathbb{E}\tilde{p}(0,t)} \neq \mathbb{E}[\alpha_{1,t}]$: we need **mean independence**.
- ▶ With a continuous z we can do a full nonparametric IV estimator: kernel-estimate $\mathbb{E}(q_t|z)$ and $\mathbb{E}(p_t|z)$ and take the ratio of derivatives $\alpha'(z) = \hat{q}'(z)/\hat{p}'(z)$ (a local Wald estimate at each z).

AIG: Takeaways

What did we learn?

- ▶ $\alpha_{1,0}$ only provides information about demand curve in range of potential price variation induced by the instrument.
- ▶ Don't know anything about demand curve outside this range!
- ▶ For different instruments z , $\alpha_{1,0}$ has a different interpretation like the LATE does. (Different from the linear model where anything works!).
- ▶ This is a bit weird: different cost shocks could trace out different paths along the demand curve– why do we care if price change came from a tax change or an input price change? Are they tracing out different subpopulations?
- ▶ We need monotonicity so that we know the range of integration $\tilde{p}(0, t) \rightarrow \tilde{p}(1, t)$ instead of $\tilde{p}(1, t) \rightarrow \tilde{p}(0, t)$
- ▶ Observations where $\tilde{p}(0, t) = \tilde{p}(1, t)$ don't factor into the average but we don't know what these observations are because potential prices are unobserved! What is the relevant sub-sample?
- ▶ When you have a parametric model, you don't need these results because we can define whatever (nonlinear) parametric functional form we want. (Parsimonious and realistic parametric functional forms are the rest of the course.)
- ▶ Caveat: this only works for a single product — with multiproduct oligopoly it is much harder to satisfy the **monotonicity** condition. (Why?)